



AURORA - BY NVEXIS - STRATEGY REPORT

App-Store Publishing, Go- to-Market & Revenue Model

Can Aurora ship to the Play Store and App Store?

What it costs, how to market it, and a realistic revenue
& expense model for a US-global and India launch.

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Executive summary

Aurora is an installable Progressive Web App (PWA) - React + Vite, hosted on Cloudflare Pages, with Supabase for data/auth and Dodo Payments (a merchant of record) for billing. It already ships a full web manifest, service worker, and branded icons, so it is **technically ready for app-store packaging today**.

- **GOOGLE PLAY - YES** A PWA can go on Google Play via a **Trusted Web Activity (TWA)** using Bubblewrap or PWABuilder. Officially supported, cheap (\$25 one-time), low-effort. Aurora qualifies with minor prep.
- **APPLE APP STORE - YES, BUT NOT AS A PLAIN PWA** Apple routinely rejects "repackaged website" wrappers under **Guideline 4.2**. To get in you must ship a real native binary (via **Capacitor**) that adds genuine native value (push notifications, share sheet, biometric unlock). Budget more time and a \$99/yr account.
- **Unit economics are healthy:** Pro at \$5.99/mo nets roughly **\$5.20/mo** after Dodo's ~6-7% merchant-of-record fees. Infrastructure is near-zero until real traction.
- **Realistic Year-1 outcome** for a well-marketed solo launch: a conservative base case is **\$5k-\$15k ARR**, with the ceiling set almost entirely by marketing reach, not by cost.

Part A - Can Aurora be published to the app stores?

What Aurora is, technically

Aurora is a client-rendered PWA served over HTTPS from Cloudflare Pages, with an installable manifest and a Workbox service worker. App stores don't host web apps directly - you wrap the PWA in a thin native container and submit that. The two platforms treat this very differently.

Google Play Store - supported and straightforward **RECOMMENDED FIRST**

Google explicitly supports PWAs on Play through a **Trusted Web Activity (TWA)**: a Chrome-backed, full-screen container that renders your live PWA with no browser chrome. Generate it with **Bubblewrap** (CLI) or **PWABuilder** (GUI).

REQUIREMENTS (AURORA ALREADY MEETS MOST)

- HTTPS (Cloudflare) and a valid web manifest with name, icons, `start_url`, display, theme/background colors - already in `vite.config.ts`.
- Lighthouse PWA quality score ≥ 80 - verify in Chrome DevTools.
- Host `/.well-known/assetlinks.json` (Digital Asset Links) with your signing key's SHA-256 - served from Cloudflare `public/`.
- Store assets: ≥ 3 phone + 2 tablet screenshots, a 1024x500 feature graphic, description, privacy policy URL.

COST & TIME

- Google Play account: **\$25 one-time**.
- Effort: **half-day to a day** with PWABuilder; review 2-7 days.

Verdict: Do this. Cheapest, fastest real "app in the store," and it reuses your live site - every web deploy updates the Android app instantly.

Apple App Store - possible, but not as a bare PWA **PLAN FOR NATIVE WORK**

Apple's **Guideline 4.2 (Minimum Functionality)** requires an app to "include features, content, and UI that elevate it beyond a repackaged website." A PWA in a WebView (e.g. PWABuilder's iOS output) is exactly what that targets and is **frequently rejected**, each rejection-resubmission cycle costing days to weeks.

THE REALISTIC PATH IN

- **Wrap with Capacitor** (not a raw WebView). Capacitor loads your web app but adds real native capabilities that satisfy 4.2:
- native **push notifications** (a strong 4.2 signal), **share sheet**, **biometric/Face ID unlock**, native file pickers, haptics.
- Add one or two genuinely native features + iOS-native splash/icons before first submission.

COST & TIME

- Apple Developer Program: **\$99/year**; requires a Mac or Mac cloud CI to build.
- Effort: **1-3 weeks** including Capacitor + native features + likely one rejection cycle.

Recommendation: Ship Google Play now. Treat iOS as Phase 2 once you have paying users - build a Capacitor shell with push notifications so it clears 4.2 first time. Meanwhile iOS users can "Add to Home Screen" in Safari and use the full PWA.

Do you even need the stores?

Both are distribution + trust channels, not requirements - Aurora already installs from the browser on both platforms. Prioritize Play early (cheap) and Apple when the ROI is clear.

Part B - Product & market analysis

Positioning

Aurora's wedge is "**all-in-one, but calm and cheap.**" Most tools force a choice: a board tool (Trello), a doc tool (Notion), a whiteboard (Miro), or a knowledge base (Obsidian). Aurora combines Kanban boards, a Notion-style block editor, an infinite collaborative canvas, calendar, to-dos, folders and reminders in one installable workspace - with a genuinely generous free tier and Pro priced like a coffee (\$5.99/mo).

Target segments

- **Solo builders & indie founders** - one tool for plan + notes + sketches; price-sensitive; value design and speed.
- **Small teams (2-10)** - shared boards + docs without paying \$10-15/seat.
- **Students & freelancers** - especially in price-sensitive markets like India; free tier + low Pro price are decisive.

Competitive landscape

Competitor	Typical price	Aurora's edge
Notion	~\$10/user/mo	Boards + canvas + reminders built in; cheaper; installable; calmer default UX
Trello	~\$5-10/user/mo	Notes, canvas & docs beyond cards; unlimited boards on Pro
ClickUp	~\$7-12/user/mo	Far simpler, less overwhelming; flat low price
Miro	~\$8-16/user/mo	Canvas is one feature, not a separate paid tool
Obsidian	Free + paid sync	Real-time collab + boards + calendar out of the box

SWOT

Strengths	Weaknesses
All-in-one; standout design; generous free tier; very low Pro price; PWA (no store gatekeeper); solid security foundation.	Solo/small team behind it; no brand awareness yet; limited support & roadmap capacity; crowded category.
Opportunities	Threats
Price-sensitive global & India markets; "calm software" trend; build-in-public audience; app-store ASO; education niche.	Incumbents bundling features; churn if reliability slips; support load; platform/payment fee changes.

Part C - Go-to-market plan

Launch channels (highest ROI first for a solo/small team)

- **Build-in-public on X / LinkedIn** - narrate the journey, show the design. Cheapest durable channel; compounds.
- **Product Hunt launch** - one big spike; prep an asset kit, a founding-member offer, a hunter; aim Tue-Thu.
- **Reddit & niche communities** - r/productivity, r/Notion (migration angle), r/SaaS, IndieHackers. Lead with value.
- **Content/SEO** - "Notion alternative", "free Trello alternative", "all-in-one project app". Compounding.
- **App-store ASO** - once on Play, optimize title/keywords/screenshots; free discovery.
- **Education/India** - student communities, regional pricing, campus ambassadors.

Conversion levers already in the product

- Generous free tier lowers signup friction; Pro gates the "wow" (canvas + media + reminders) - natural upgrade triggers.
- A **founding-member price** (annual, anchored) drives early cash and loyalty.
- In-app upgrade prompts at the moment of need (board/member limit; opening the canvas).

Part D - Revenue & expense model

All figures are planning estimates, not guarantees. Revenue here is dominated by marketing reach and retention, which are hard to predict for a new brand. Ranges are deliberately conservative.

Unit economics (per Pro subscriber)

Item	Monthly	Annual plan
List price (USD)	\$5.99	\$68.29 (~\$5.69/mo)
Dodo fee (MoR): 4% + \$0.40 base, +1.5% intl, +0.5% sub - ~6% + \$0.40 blended	-\$0.76	-\$4.50
Net revenue	~ \$5.23/mo	~ \$63.8/yr
Marginal infra cost / user	~ \$0 until scale (free tiers); pennies/user thereafter	

Dodo is a **merchant of record**: it takes on sales-tax/VAT compliance and chargebacks for a higher rate than a bare processor. For a solo operator selling globally, that compliance offload is usually worth ~6-7%.

Fixed & recurring costs

Cost	Early (pre-traction)	At ~1,000 active users
Supabase (DB/auth/storage)	\$0 (free)	\$25/mo (Pro)

Cloudflare Pages (hosting)	\$0	\$0
Resend (reminder emails)	\$0 (free 3k/mo)	\$20/mo
Domain	~\$12/yr	~\$12/yr
Google Play (one-time)	\$25	-
Apple Developer (if iOS)	\$99/yr	\$99/yr
Dodo fees	Variable, ~6-7% of revenue (only when you earn)	
One-off pen-test (pre-launch)	\$4,000-\$8,000 (see companion report)	

Takeaway: your only material fixed cost before real revenue is the optional pen-test and ~\$1-2k/yr of platform floors. This is a near-zero-burn business until it works.

Scenario model - US / global (USD), 12 months

Scenario	Signups yr1	Free->Pro	Pro subs	Net MRR	Net ARR	Costs/yr	Profit
Conservative	1,000	2%	20	~\$105	~\$1.3k	~\$0.4k	~\$0.9k
Base	5,000	3%	150	~\$785	~\$9.4k	~\$0.9k	~\$8.5k
Optimistic	20,000	4%	800	~\$4,180	~\$50k	~\$3k	~\$47k

Assumes ~\$5.23 net/Pro/mo, freemium free->paid of 2-4% (typical SaaS is 2-5%), modest churn. Costs include Supabase/Resend scaling + Apple + support tooling; excludes your time and the one-off pen-test.

Scenario model - India-first (regional pricing)

India buyers convert on price. Use Dodo regional pricing to sell Pro at ~₹199/mo (~\$2.30) or ₹1,499/yr. ARPU is ~40% of the USD plan, but the student/indie base is large; expect **lower conversion (1-2%)** and higher volume.

Scenario	Signups yr1	Free->Pro	Pro subs	Net MRR (~)	Net ARR (~)
Conservative	3,000	1%	30	~\$60	~\$0.7k
Base	12,000	1.5%	180	~\$360	~\$4.3k
Optimistic	40,000	2%	800	~\$1,600	~\$19k

Net assumes ~\$2.00/Pro/mo after fees at ₹199. India volume can exceed the US, but revenue/user is lower - the winning play is usually **USD pricing globally + regional (PPP) pricing for India**, which Dodo supports across 220+ countries.

Honest expectations

- Most new indie SaaS never cross \$1k MRR - not because of cost, but **distribution**. Your edge is a strong product and near-zero burn, so you can keep iterating cheaply.
- Realistic 12-month target for a committed solo launch with consistent marketing is the **Base case (~\$5k-\$10k ARR)**, with upside if a launch or channel breaks out.
- Retention > acquisition: with tiny costs, every retained Pro user is almost pure margin. Invest in reliability, onboarding, and the canvas "wow".

Recommended 90-day plan

1. Finish security remediation (done) - optional focused pen-test before charging at scale.
2. Ship to **Google Play via PWABuilder** (half-1 day) and add `asset links.json`.
3. Turn on **regional pricing** in Dodo (USD global + INR for India).
4. Prepare a **Product Hunt** launch + founding-member annual offer; seed Reddit/IndieHackers.
5. Start build-in-public content; publish 2-3 SEO "alternative to..." pages.
6. Only after paying-user signal: build the **Capacitor iOS** app with push notifications for the App Store.

Sources

MobiLoud, "Can You Publish a PWA to the App Store and Google Play? (2026)"; Google for Developers, "Adding your PWA to Google Play"; Android Developers, "Trusted Web Activities"; PWABuilder Blog, "Publish your PWA to the iOS App Store"; Apple App Store Review Guidelines section 4.2; Dodo Payments, "Pricing" and "Cheapest Merchant of Record for SaaS (2026)". Cross-checked July 2026; treat projections as estimates.